

Expense Policy

Policy number: POL-FIN-001 **Owner:** Elena Petrova, Controller **Approved by:** Daniel Reyes, CFO
Effective date: 1 March 2026

1. Purpose

This policy explains which business expenses Northwind Labs reimburses, the limits that apply and how to claim them. Travel-specific rules (flights, hotels and per diems) are covered by the Travel Policy, POL-TRV-002. Where the two documents overlap, the Travel Policy takes precedence for travel costs.

2. General rules

- Expenses must be necessary for Northwind business, reasonable and supported by a receipt.
- Every expense is claimed in **Expensify**. Paper forms and email claims are not accepted.
- Submit expenses **within 30 days** of the date the cost was incurred. Claims older than 90 days are rejected unless the Controller approves an exception.
- An itemised receipt is required for every expense of **\$25 or more** (or €25 / 100 PLN). For smaller amounts a short description is enough.
- You may not approve your own expenses, and you may not split a single purchase into smaller claims to stay under a limit.
- Expenses are reimbursed in your payroll currency with the next monthly payroll run after approval.

3. Approval

Claim amount	Approver
Up to \$1,000	Direct manager
\$1,000.01 to \$5,000	Direct manager and department VP
Above \$5,000	Department VP and Controller

Purchases of software, services or equipment from suppliers are not personal reimbursements; they need a purchase order raised by Finance Operations (ask in #finance-ops) and are not covered by this policy.

4. Corporate cards

Employees who travel more than six times per year, and all managers in Sales, may request a Northwind corporate card (issued by Ramp). Corporate card transactions sync to Expensify automatically and must have a receipt attached within 7 days. Personal purchases on a corporate card are not allowed, even if you intend to repay them.

5. Reimbursement limits

The table below lists the standard limits. Amounts are in USD; employees paid in EUR or PLN use the equivalent shown in Expensify, which is updated every January.

Category	Limit	Notes
Client meals and entertainment	\$90 per person	Includes tax and tip; list all attendees and their companies
Team meals (internal only)	\$40 per person	Max one per month per team; needs manager pre-approval
Working lunch with a candidate	\$35 per person	Record the candidate name in the claim
Home office equipment	\$600 one-time	Desk, chair, monitor, headset; first 6 months of employment
Home internet	\$45 per month	Remote and hybrid employees only
Mobile phone plan	\$50 per month	Only for roles on the eligible list maintained by Finance
Co-working space	\$250 per month	Fully remote employees with no Northwind office within 50 km
Professional memberships	\$400 per year	e.g. IEEE, ACM, CFA Institute
Late-night taxi home	\$60 per trip	After 21:00 when work requires staying late
Gifts to customers	\$100 per recipient per year	Must also follow POL-LGL-004 (Anti-Bribery and Gifts)

Books, courses and conference tickets are paid from your personal learning budget (see the Learning Budget page in the handbook), not from these categories.

5.1 Alcohol

Alcohol is reimbursable only as part of a client meal or an approved team celebration, and never above two drinks per person. Spirits bought at retail are never reimbursed.

6. Expenses that are not reimbursed

- Personal clothing, grooming and toiletries
- Fines, penalties and parking tickets
- Personal subscriptions (streaming, news, fitness) unless listed in section 5
- Gifts to colleagues paid personally (use the People team's celebration process instead)
- Annual fees of personal credit cards and currency conversion fees above 3%
- Charitable donations made in Northwind's name without approval from the CFO

7. Lost receipts

If you lose a receipt for an expense of \$25 or more, complete the "Missing receipt declaration" in Expensify. Missing-receipt declarations are limited to three per calendar year. After that, expenses without receipts are not reimbursed.

8. Audits and misuse

Finance audits a random 10% sample of expense reports every month, plus every report over \$5,000. Submitting a false or inflated claim is treated as gross misconduct. Reimbursements paid in error are recovered from the next payroll.

9. Help and contacts

- Questions about categories and limits: Slack #ask-finance
- Expensify access problems: #it-help
- Exceptions to this policy: Elena Petrova, Controller

10. Revision history

Version	Date	Change
POL-FIN-001 v1	March 2021	First version
POL-FIN-001 v2	January 2024	Added co-working and home internet categories
POL-FIN-001 v3	March 2026	Raised client meal limit, added candidate lunches, linked to Travel Policy POL-TRV-002